

Profile Summary

Benefiting from impactful roles at Chevron, Dell Technologies, and Hewlett-Packard Enterprise, I bring extensive experience in steering Agile transformations. My expertise as a seasoned Release Train Engineer is evident in my ability to cultivate collaboration, implement Agile methodologies, and drive tangible outcomes. Committed to delivering impactful solutions, I am poised to contribute to your organization's journey towards success.

Work Experience

Employer: Problem-To-Solution | Client: Chevron

January 2022 -

Release Train Engineer

Lead the Financial Solutions Release Train: Direct a 150-member team, including 7 Scrum Masters, 5 Product Owners, 70 Engineers, 10 Architects, 20 Financial Analysts, 8 UX/UI Designers, 5 Data Scientists, 10 Quality Assurance Specialists, 10 Business Analysts, and 5 DevOps Engineers. Focus on solving critical business problems such as ensuring regulatory compliance, enhancing customer experience, improving operational efficiency, leveraging data-driven decision making, and accelerating product innovation. Through Agile methodologies, achieve significant improvements in regulatory compliance, customer satisfaction, operational efficiency, and time-to-market for new financial products.

- **Develop Release Strategies:** Formulate and communicate the vision and strategy for Agile transformations, partnering with stakeholders, including Product Managers, to develop the transformation roadmap.
- **Facilitate PI Planning:** Coordinate and lead Program Increment (PI) planning sessions, ensuring alignment of team objectives with business goals and managing dependencies across teams.
- **Monitor and Track Progress:** Oversee the execution of the PI plans, track progress, and ensure transparency through the use of metrics and dashboards. Report on key performance indicators (KPIs) such as team velocity, predictability, and feature completion rates.
- **Coordinate with Product Management:** Work closely with Product Managers to gather and prioritize requirements from diverse stakeholders, translating them into actionable tasks and maintaining the release backlog.
- **Ensure Alignment:** Ensure that cross-functional teams, including development, QA, UX/UI, and DevOps, are aligned with the business strategy and objectives, managing multiple development streams and resolving dependencies.
- **Support Continuous Improvement:** Drive continuous improvement initiatives by analyzing trends and impediments through burndown and burnup charts, facilitating discussions to address issues promptly.
- **Facilitate Collaboration:** Promote collaboration and communication across teams to ensure smooth execution and delivery of high-quality products.
- **Quality Assurance:** Oversee user acceptance testing to ensure that releases meet the expectations of business stakeholders and customers.
- **Manage Risks and Issues:** Identify, assess, and mitigate risks and issues that may impact the successful delivery of program increments.

Outcomes:

- Increased responsiveness to market and regulatory changes, leading to faster response times and more agile decision-making processes.
- Enhanced collaboration and coordination across teams, resulting in higher productivity and more cohesive project execution.
- Improved risk management through early identification and mitigation of risks, reducing project delays and increasing predictability.
- Continuous improvement through regular feedback loops and iterative enhancements, leading to ongoing improvements in processes, products, and team performance.

Employer: Problem-To-Solution | Client: Dell Technologies

March 2018 - January 2022

Release Train Engineer

Business Problem: Dell Technologies faced challenges in effectively managing the integration of newly acquired technologies and systems into its existing product portfolio. The lack of standardized processes and alignment between different business units hindered the seamless integration of acquisitions, leading to delays, inefficiencies, and missed opportunities for innovation and growth.

Solution: As the Product Owner, I spearheaded the implementation of Agile methodologies, particularly Scrum, to streamline the integration of newly acquired technologies and systems at Dell Technologies. By establishing standardized processes, fostering collaboration between different business units, and prioritizing integration efforts based on strategic objectives, I ensured the seamless integration of acquisitions, enabling Dell to capitalize on new market opportunities more effectively.

- **Define Integration Roadmap and Strategy:** Collaborate with Product Managers to formulate and communicate the vision and strategy for integrating newly acquired technologies, ensuring alignment with organizational goals and objectives.
- **Prioritize Integration Backlog:** Support Product Managers in prioritizing integration backlog items based on business value, technology dependencies, and market impact.
- **Facilitate PI Planning:** Coordinate Planning Interval (PI) planning sessions to align team objectives with business goals and manage dependencies across teams.
- **Collaborate with Cross-Functional Teams:** Work closely with cross-functional teams to define integration requirements and dependencies, ensuring clarity and feasibility.
- **Oversee Integration Sprints:** Supervise Scrum Masters who lead daily standups, retrospectives, and sprint planning sessions. Ensure the execution of regular integration sprints to iteratively deliver integration solutions and validate functionality.
- **Gather Feedback:** Collect feedback from stakeholders and end-users to iterate on integration solutions and enhance user experience.

Contributions to Address Dependencies:

- **Stakeholder Collaboration:** Foster stakeholder and leadership collaboration through transparent communication and alignment sessions. Ensure integration efforts align with strategic objectives.
- **Team Training and Education:** Conduct training sessions to enhance team proficiency in Agile methodologies and integration best practices, reducing skill gaps and implementation roadblocks.
- **Metrics and Reporting:** Track and report KPIs such as team velocity, predictability, and integration completion rates to drive continuous improvement.

Agile Project Manager / Scrum Master

March 2014 - March 2018

Business Problem: Following the corporate split of Hewlett Packard into two companies in late 2015, Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) encountered significant challenges in scaling Agile adoption across its newly formed organization. The organizational restructuring resulted in disparate business units and geographically dispersed teams, leading to complexities in coordinating Agile practices and aligning development efforts. Limited success with Agile methods on individual teams further compounded the situation, hindering the organization's responsiveness to user requests, environmental changes, and software development costs.

Solution: As an Agile Transformation Consultant, I played a pivotal role in guiding HPE through its Agile expansion journey using the Scaled Agile Framework® (SAFe®). Collaborating closely with cross-functional teams across multiple locations, I facilitated the adoption of SAFe principles and practices to drive organizational agility and enhance software development processes. By leveraging SAFe's structured framework, training, and coaching materials, I enabled HPE to accelerate delivery, reduce defects, and align Agile practices with strategic business objectives.

- Orchestrated the successful launch of multiple Agile Release Trains (ARTs), enabling cross-functional collaboration and alignment on strategic priorities across HPE's global organization.
 - Reduced defects by 20% through the implementation of Agile best practices and continuous improvement initiatives, enhancing product quality and customer satisfaction.
 - Trained and certified over a thousand team members on SAFe principles and practices, fostering a culture of Agile excellence and innovation throughout HPE.
 - Guided HPE's leadership in embracing Agile as a strategic enabler for meeting business goals, driving organizational alignment, and maximizing value delivery.
 - Contributed to HPE's competitive advantage by aligning Agile practices with strategic business objectives, enabling the organization to respond rapidly to market demands and customer needs.
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- **Contributions to Dependencies:**
 - **Executive Alignment:** Facilitated alignment sessions with senior leadership to secure buy-in and commitment to Agile adoption as a strategic imperative. Built consensus among key stakeholders to ensure organizational alignment and support for Agile transformation efforts.

Certifications

Scaled Agile Inc.

SAFe Release Train Engineer (RTE)

Scaled Agile Inc.

SAFe Product Owner / Product Manager (POPM)

Scaled Agile Inc.

SAFe Scrum Master (SSM)

MOS 92Y

Unit Supply Specialist

Education

Ashford University

Bachelor of Art in Supply Chain Management

Skills

- Agile
- Alignment
- ART Sync
- Backlog Prioritization
- Burnup Chart
- Burndown Chart
- Collaboration
- Communication
- Continuous Deployment
- Continuous Exploration
- Continuous Improvement
- Continuous Integration
- Cross-Functional Teams
- Daily Standup
- Dependency Management
- DevOps
- DevOps and Continuous Delivery Pipeline
- Drive Relentless Improvement
- Epics
- Facilitate Agile Release Train (ART) Events
- Feature Completion
- Feedback Loops
- Facilitate PI Planning (Planning Interval)
- Inspect and Adapt
- Integration
- Integration Sprints
- Iterative Development
- Kanban
- Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)
- Lean
- Lean-Agile Leadership
- Manage and Optimize Flow
- Metrics
- PI System Demo
- Planning Interval (PI) Planning
- Predictability
- Prioritize Integration Backlog
- Process Improvement
- Product Backlog
- Program Increment
- Program Predictability Measure
- Quality Assurance
- Release Train Engineer (RTE)
- Requirements Gathering
- Retrospectives
- Risk Management
- Roadmap
- SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework)
- Scrum
- Scrum Master
- Stakeholder Collaboration
- Strategy
- Support Program Execution
- Team Facilitation
- Training
- Transparency
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT)
- User Stories
- Value Stream Coordination
- Value Stream Mapping
- Velocity